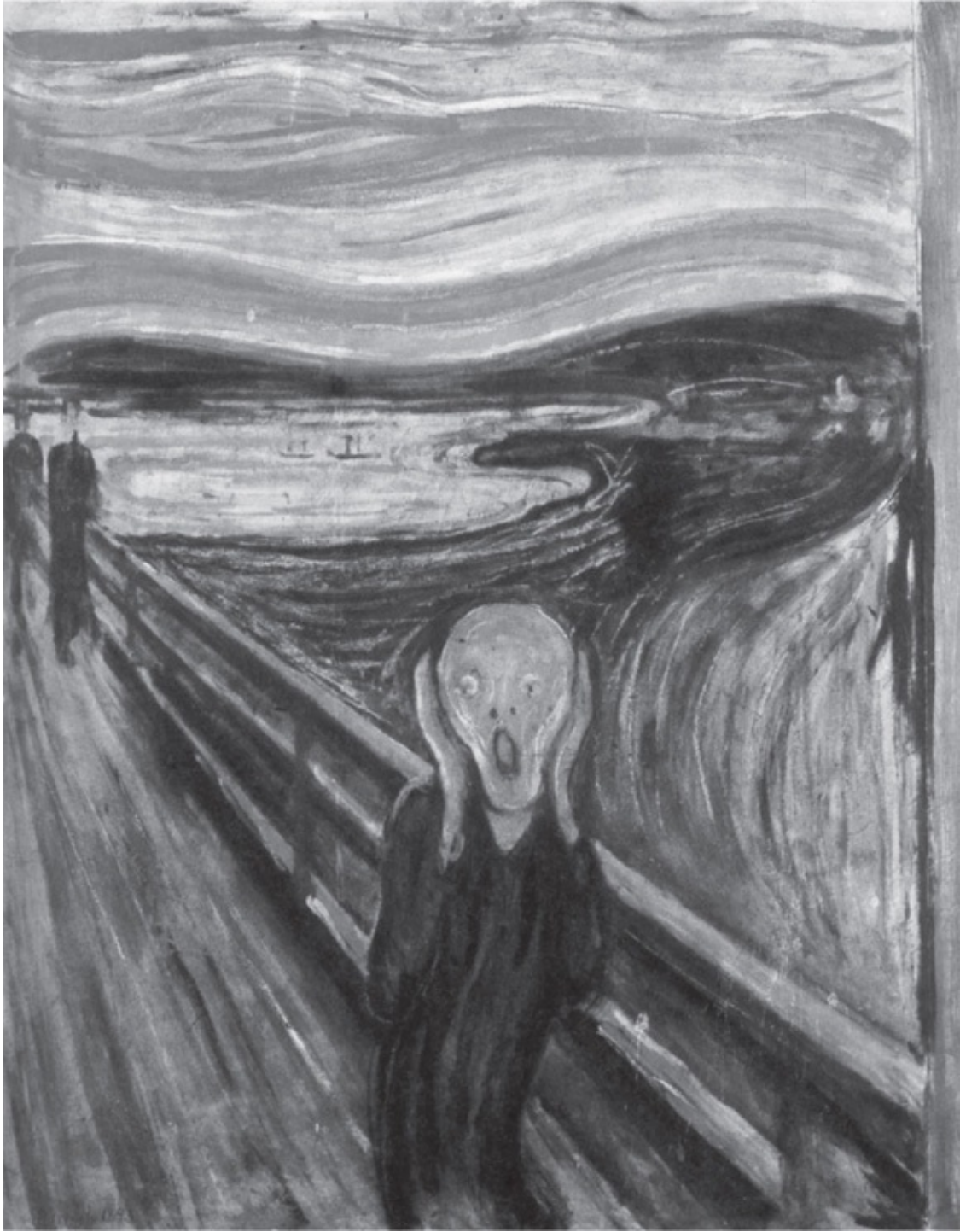


Munch

Norwegian artist and forerunner of Expressionism, Edvard Munch (1863–1944) produced paintings and prints that portray psychological and emotional themes with fluid lines and bold colours, expressing his experiences of bereavement, sickness, rejection, despair, loneliness and depression. His early paintings were naturalistic, but after visiting Paris in 1885, he was inspired by the Impressionists to try new colours and brushstroke techniques. During a second Parisian visit in 1889–90, he studied in the studio of Léon Bonnat (1833–1922), and became influenced by the Neo-Impressionists, Van Gogh, Gauguin and Toulouse-Lautrec. Changing his palette, he used colours to convey emotion, and also followed ideas he had seen in Symbolist paintings. In 1892, he exhibited his new, expressive works at Germany's Verein der Berliner Künstler, where they provoked fierce controversy. Yet he continued working in his sketchy, unfinished style to reveal his intensely personal feelings about such things as isolation, sexuality, death and uncertainty, in an emotive way that was immediately understood by viewers.



Munch, *The Scream*, 1893